Public itinerary

Ireland 2026

Presentations at Mary Immaculate College and the Literacy Association of Ireland (LAI) Annual Conference, Limerick · 4–7 November 2026

Andrea C. Borowczak, Ed.D., and Mike Borowczak, Ph.D. · University of Central Florida

At a glance

Irish time (GMT). Rooms are at Mary Immaculate College (MIC), South Circular Road, Limerick.

Day	Time	Session	Room	Presenters
Wed 4	12:00–13:00	**Seminar: From Ideas to Impact**	G10	Andrea C. Borowczak and Mike Borowczak
Wed 4	14:00–15:00	**PME Year 1: The CRAFT Pedagogical Cycle with AI**	206	Mike Borowczak and Andrea C. Borowczak
Thu 5	09:00–10:00	**PME Year 2: Partnering Science and Art**	T116	Andrea C. Borowczak
Thu 5	Late morning	**micro:bit Workshop: Code a Tiny Computer**	MIC	Mike Borowczak
Fri 6	18:00–21:00	**LAI Conference opening evening**	T118	Conference program
Sat 7	08:15–10:00	**Registration, welcome, and keynote**	Tara Building	Conference program
Sat 7	10:15–10:45	**Leading Teachers Through AI**	T214	Mike Borowczak and Andrea C. Borowczak
Sat 7	10:45–11:15	**Check the Machine**	T214	Andrea C. Borowczak and Mike Borowczak
Sat 7	11:15–11:45	**GenAI Literacy in Teacher Education**	T214	TJ Ó Ceallaigh and Stephen Murphy

Sessions

Session descriptions as prepared for the hosts.

Wed 4 Nov
12:00–13:00
Seminar

Seminar: From Ideas to Impact Ours

Room G10 · Andrea C. Borowczak and Mike Borowczak

Arts+STEM Hub Seminar, Mary Immaculate College · for MIC staff and research students

Publishing and leading in STEM education research. We trace our partnership from doctoral programs at the University of Cincinnati to 86 shared peer-reviewed works, then three parts: finding research puzzles where subjects meet, publishable work as two editors read it (with contribution sentences drafted in mixed groups of three), and leading through service in each other's communities.

Wed 4 Nov
14:00–15:00
Session

PME Year 1: The CRAFT Pedagogical Cycle with AI Ours

Room 206 · Mike Borowczak and Andrea C. Borowczak

Professional Master of Education (PME), Digital Technologies and Science Education I · primary student teachers

Student teachers predict first (why do we have seasons?) and then see what an AI chatbot wrote. From there: CRAFT's two commitments and five phases, one primary science lesson planned with AI phase by phase with the Check the Machine routine in the Fortify phase, and groups of three planning their own lesson with AI on the CRAFT planner.

Thu 5 Nov
09:00–10:00
Session

PME Year 2: Partnering Science and Art Ours

Room T116 · Andrea C. Borowczak

Professional Master of Education (PME), Digital Technologies and Science Education II · primary student teachers

Arts and STEM partnerships in the primary classroom. Ninety seconds of drawing a satellite image of a river opens the session, then the practices science and art share, Andrea's silk-batik methods unit with 52 pre-service teachers, partnership levels from the LIFT balloon teams, and a test for how deeply two subjects partner. Groups of three plan a partnered lesson with a named partner.

Thu 5 Nov
Workshop

micro:bit Workshop: Code a Tiny Computer Ours

Mike Borowczak

CRAFT Maker Space, Mary Immaculate College · a visiting primary class

Teams of three (Coder, Tester, Reporter) code, download, and run programs on a BBC micro:bit: a name badge, shake dice, then a choice of thermometer, night light, step counter, or secret messages by radio. Backup and second station: Sort and Search, Unplugged, with pupils acting as a binary search tree.

Fri 6 Nov
18:00–21:00
Conference

LAI Conference opening evening

Room T118

Literacy Association of Ireland (LAI) Annual Conference · Tara Building, MIC

18:00	Registration
18:30	Welcome: Dermot Nestor (MIC President) and Sylvaine Ní Aogáin (LAI President)
18:45	LAI Award for Inspiring Literacy Leadership
19:00	Teach Meet
19:35	Launch of the LAI 2025 proceedings
19:45	Biennial Award for an Outstanding Master's Thesis
20:00	Fireside chat with Déirdre Kirwan
20:30	Poster reception, An tSlí (outside T118)

Sat 7 Nov
08:15–10:00
Conference

Registration, welcome, and keynote

Tara Building

LAI Annual Conference · Tara Building, MIC

08:15 Registration
09:00 Welcome: Angela Canny, Acting Dean of Education, MIC
09:10 Keynote: Teresa Cremin CBE, Reading for Pleasure: The 3 Rs

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Sat 7 Nov
10:15–10:45
Paper

Leading Teachers Through AI Ours

Room T214 · Mike Borowczak and Andrea C. Borowczak

LAI Annual Conference · AI and Literacy session · A CRAFT-framed professional development study for multiliteracy leadership

Two CRAFT workshops with K–12 teachers in the Western Regional Noyce Network. Most teachers said their students use AI secretly. After one workshop, confidence rose on every item and checking AI output rose least; a second session built on checking moved it further, and the teachers' own writing shows the same gap. What this means for anyone who leads teacher learning.

Sat 7 Nov
10:45–11:15
Paper

Check the Machine Ours

Room T214 · Andrea C. Borowczak and Mike Borowczak

LAI Annual Conference · AI and Literacy session · A classroom protocol for early critical AI literacy

The routine run live with the room on a seasons question: write your own answer first (the Before step), compare it with what one AI wrote (the After step), and name what writing first let you see (the Takeaway step). Then what teachers' first runs looked like and how the routine adapts for the early grades.

Sat 7 Nov
11:15–11:45
Paper

GenAI Literacy in Teacher Education

Room T214 · TJ Ó Ceallaigh and Stephen Murphy

LAI Annual Conference · AI and Literacy session · the third paper in our session

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Updated 1 November 2026. Times follow the hosts' and the LAI program as of this date and may change.